



FOUR-COURSE SYSTEM

COURSE 3 - DATA ENGINEERING 2026

C3-014A Gate Review - Dropzone Auditor

Protected competency diagnosis | no copy-ready final solution

Artifact	C3_014A_GATE_REVIEW_PROTECTED_RC1
Status	PROTECTED - OPEN AFTER FROZEN ATTEMPT
Teaching standard	M01 beginner-first teacher loop; book remains sufficient without video.
Bridge boundary	Course 2B competencies may be assumed; all new engineering concepts still start from first principles.
Brand	Charcoal #1F2937 Teal #14B8A6 Soft Blue #3B82F6 AMOLED #000

House rule: understand -> follow once -> see expected result -> break/fix -> do a changed version -> validate -> explain -> save evidence. A running command alone never counts as mastery.

Use this only after the Gate attempt is frozen

For each competency, mark PASS only from evidence. A failure in one competency blocks Gate PASS regardless of strength elsewhere. Do not convert this into a numeric average.

DIAGNOSIS TABLE

ID	Look for	If weak, repair only this
C1	Input/output grain, rules, failure, rerun and independent validation are explicit.	Restate one-row grain, required fields, output contract, failure, rerun and independent control on changed data.
C2	Correct shell/path; inspect before destructive action; source/evidence handling safe.	Reproduce smallest filesystem operation in Linux-native test folder; use inspection-first recovery.
C3	Reviewable branch/commits; no secret/venv/bytecode; diff understood.	Use status/diff/staged-diff; remove disposable/secret artifacts; create a fresh changed branch/commit exercise.
C4	Clean venv/dependency recreation proven.	Delete only disposable venv, recreate from dependency files, rerun tests.
C5	Core/CLI boundary + documented config precedence + no secret leakage.	Separate core/CLI; prove config precedence; run secret scan.
C6	Actionable logs; known failure non-zero; unexpected error not swallowed.	Reproduce one known validation failure + one unexpected failure; ensure non-zero/trace context.
C7	Tests protect contract incl. failure/edge case; deliberate regression is catchable.	Add a test that fails under an intentionally injected regression, then restore code.
C8	Useful help, stable invocation/output and machine-readable failure behavior.	Repair help/argument/exit/output contract on a changed tiny CLI.
C9	Image/container/mount/runtime reasoning correct; real Docker evidence or honest approved fallback.	Explain image/container/mount; if real Docker available prove client+server and tiny run; otherwise document blocker honestly.
C10	Safe rerun demonstrated; operator can reproduce/validate/recover from runbook.	Define intended rerun state, run twice on changed case, compare, and revise runbook.

CRITICAL FAILURE CHECK

- Real secret/token/key exposed in submitted source/log/evidence.
- Fabricated command/runtime/Docker evidence.
- Destructive unsafe operation or data loss without justified recovery control.
- Contract failure exits success or publishes a known-invalid result.
- Protected review opened/copied before first attempt is frozen.
- First-attempt evidence overwritten/rewritten after review.
- Unresolved plausible wrong result with no independent validation.

NEXT ROUTE

If Gate A has targeted weaknesses, complete only assigned remediation + changed micro-retest. Gate B/C do not unlock automatically. A fresh full retest requires explicit assignment and must use its unseen case.